



COUNTRY BROCHURE

RESIDENCY BY INVESTMENT | COUNTRY GUIDE

Canada Residency by Investment

Ten provincial entrepreneur and investor routes to Canadian permanent residency, with verified 2026 investment thresholds. Canada's two federal business routes are closed.

PROGRAMMES

15

CAPITAL

Ottawa

CURRENCY

Canadian Dollar
(CAD)

LANGUAGE

English and
French

Canada at a glance

CAPITAL Ottawa	POPULATION 40,400,000
LANGUAGE English and French	CURRENCY Canadian Dollar (CAD)
TIME ZONE Multiple (UTC-3.5 to UTC-8)	CLIMATE Varies from temperate to sub-arctic; cold winters and mild summers.
PROGRAMMES WE ADVISE ON 15	

Overview

Canada offers one of the most comprehensive business immigration frameworks worldwide. Through its Provincial Nominee Programs (PNPs), qualified entrepreneurs and business owners can establish or purchase a business, create local employment, and secure Canadian permanent residency. Canada's two federal business routes, the Start-Up Visa and the Self-Employed Persons Program, are closed to new applications.

Each open stream reflects its province's or territory's economic priorities — from business development in British Columbia, the Atlantic provinces and the North to primary agriculture in Alberta. Successful applicants usually receive a work permit to launch operations, followed by nomination for permanent residency after meeting the conditions of a performance agreement.

Key points

- Ten provincial entrepreneur streams are open. Both federal business routes are closed.
- Routes for entrepreneurs, investors and farmers, across nine provinces and territories.
- No single national threshold — investment ranges from CAD \$100,000 to CAD \$300,000 by province and region.
- Provincial Nominee Program admissions were raised to 91,500 for 2026, up from 55,000 in 2025.
- Eligible for Canadian citizenship after three years of residence as a permanent resident.

Programmes in Canada



Alberta Advantage Immigration Program (AAIP)

Start or purchase a farm in Alberta and secure Permanent Residency through Canada's dedicated Self-Employed Farmer Stream.

From CAD 500,000 | 18 months



BC PNP Entrepreneur Immigration – Base Category

Invest in or start a business in BC and gain Canadian permanent residency.

From CAD 200,000 | 20 months



BC PNP Entrepreneur Immigration – Regional Stream

Start a business in regional BC and obtain Canadian permanent residency.

From CAD 100,000 | 18 months



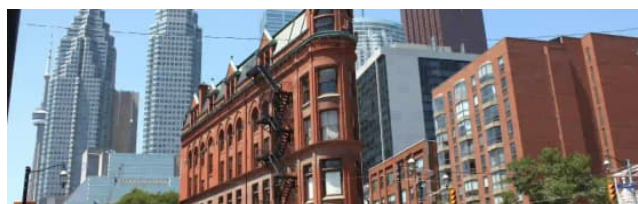
Canada Start-Up Visa – Closed to New Applications

IRCC paused the Start-Up Visa on 30 June 2026. New applications stopped on 31 December 2025. This page records what happened and which routes are still open.



Federal Self-Employed Persons Program – Paused

Intake closed on 30 April 2024 and IRCC extended the pause until further notice on 19 December 2025. No new application can be filed.



Manitoba Business Investor Stream – Entrepreneur Pathway

Start, invest in or buy a business in Manitoba and work toward Canadian permanent residency through the MPNP Business Investor Stream.

From CAD 150,000 | 24 months



New Brunswick Business Immigration Stream – NBNP

Invest from CAD \$150,000 in a New Brunswick business and work toward Canadian permanent residency. This stream replaced the closed Entrepreneurial Stream.

From CAD 150,000 | 20 months



Newfoundland & Labrador – International Entrepreneur Stream

Establish, purchase, or manage a business in Newfoundland & Labrador and pursue a pathway to Canadian Permanent Residency.

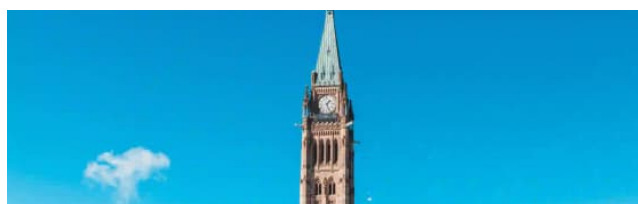
From CAD 200,000 | 20 months



Northwest Territories Business Stream – NTNP Entrepreneur Program

Invest from CAD \$100,000 outside Yellowknife, or CAD \$200,000 within it, and obtain Canadian permanent residency through the NTNP Business Stream.

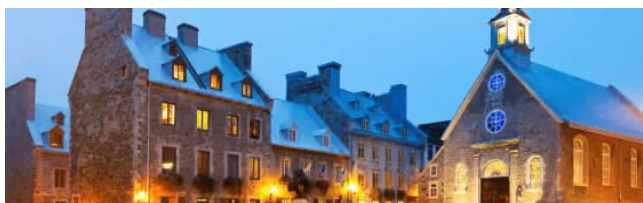
From CAD 100,000 | 24 months



Nova Scotia Entrepreneur Stream – Business Immigration

Invest from CAD \$100,000 outside Halifax, or CAD \$150,000 within it, operate the business for a year, and be nominated for Canadian permanent residency.

From CAD 100,000 | 24 months



Ontario OINP Entrepreneur Stream – Closed

Ontario closed the OINP Entrepreneur Stream and archived its page. The province is consolidating the OINP into a redesigned Workforce Priority model.



Prince Edward Island Work Permit Stream

Invest in and manage a business in Prince Edward Island to obtain Canadian permanent residency.

From CAD 150,000 | 18 months



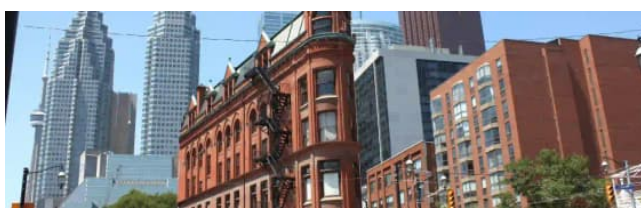
Saskatchewan SINP Entrepreneur Category – Permanently Closed

Saskatchewan permanently closed all SINP Entrepreneur and Farm pathways on 27 March 2025. No new applications, expressions of interest or invitations are being issued.



Saskatchewan Farm Owner & Young Farmer Stream – Permanently Closed

Saskatchewan permanently closed its Farm Owner/Operator pathway on 27 March 2025, alongside all SINP entrepreneur categories.



Yukon Business Stream – YNP Entrepreneur Immigration

Start or invest in a business in Yukon to gain Canadian permanent residency through the YNP program.

From CAD 300,000 | 24 months

Provincial pathways that are open

- **British Columbia — Entrepreneur Immigration, Base stream** Investment from CAD \$200,000; net worth CAD \$600,000.
- **British Columbia — Entrepreneur Immigration, Regional stream** Investment from CAD \$100,000; net worth CAD \$300,000. No longer a pilot — BC made it a permanent part of the BC PNP on 27 May 2024.
- **Prince Edward Island — Work Permit Stream** Investment from CAD \$150,000; net worth CAD \$600,000. PR through a work permit and a performance agreement.
- **Nova Scotia — Entrepreneur stream** Investment from CAD \$150,000 inside Halifax or CAD \$100,000 outside it; net worth CAD \$600,000 or CAD \$400,000. A CAD \$2,000 application fee applies from 1 September 2026.
- **New Brunswick — Business Immigration Stream** Investment from CAD \$150,000; net worth CAD \$500,000 (CAD \$300,000 for farming). This stream replaced the closed Entrepreneurial Stream.
- **Newfoundland & Labrador — International Entrepreneur** Investment from CAD \$200,000; net worth CAD \$600,000; operate the business for a year before nomination.
- **Northwest Territories — Business Stream** Investment from CAD \$200,000 within Yellowknife or CAD \$100,000 outside it; net worth CAD \$500,000 or CAD \$250,000. Exploratory visit and interview required; no deposit.
- **Manitoba — Business Investor Stream, Entrepreneur Pathway** Net worth CAD \$500,000. Investment is indicatively CAD \$250,000 in the Manitoba Capital Region or CAD \$150,000 outside it; Manitoba does not publish a fixed threshold and sets the exact amount individually in your Business Performance Agreement.
- **Alberta — Self-Employed Farmer Stream** Net worth and equity of CAD \$500,000 in primary agriculture. Open, but only 60 nominations across all Alberta entrepreneur streams for 2026 against 217 applications already in

process.

- **Yukon — Business Nominee Program** Investment from CAD \$300,000; net worth CAD \$500,000.

Pathways that have closed

None of these accepts a new application. Each has its own page with the official closure dates and the routes that remain open.

- **Federal Start-Up Visa** — paused 30 June 2026; intake ended 31 December 2025.
- **Federal Self-Employed Persons Program** — intake closed 30 April 2024; pause extended indefinitely on 19 December 2025.
- **Ontario OINP Entrepreneur Stream** — closed; Ontario has archived the page.
- **Saskatchewan Entrepreneur Category** — permanently closed 27 March 2025.
- **Saskatchewan Farm Owner & Young Farmer Stream** — permanently closed 27 March 2025.

The federal Business category is set at **500 admissions a year** under the 2026-2028 Immigration Levels Plan, which is the clearest explanation of why both federal entrepreneur routes were shut. Provincial Nominee Program admissions, by contrast, were raised to **91,500 for 2026** after being halved to 55,000 in 2025.

How the application works

- 1 Choose the suitable provincial entrepreneur stream with XIPHIAS experts.
- 2 Submit an Expression of Interest (EOI) outlining your business concept.
- 3 Receive an invitation to apply and complete net-worth verification and business plan submission.
- 4 Attend a mandatory interview and/or exploratory visit where required.
- 5 Obtain a temporary work permit to establish or manage your business in Canada.
- 6 Fulfil investment and job-creation conditions under a performance agreement.
- 7 Apply for permanent residency nomination upon successful operation.

General requirements

- Legally acquired net worth, typically CAD \$250,000 to CAD \$600,000 depending on province and region.
- Minimum investment from CAD \$100,000 to CAD \$300,000 depending on location.
- Business ownership or senior management experience — usually three years.
- Language: CLB 4 or CLB 5 in English or French, depending on the stream.
- A business plan and active day-to-day management within Canada.
- Clean criminal record and admissibility under IRCC standards.

Questions clients ask

Which provinces still run entrepreneur or investor programmes?

Ten streams across nine provinces and territories: British Columbia (Base and Regional), Prince Edward Island, Nova Scotia, New Brunswick, Newfoundland & Labrador, Northwest Territories, Manitoba, Alberta and Yukon. Ontario and Saskatchewan have closed theirs.

Is the federal Start-Up Visa still available?

No. IRCC paused it on 30 June 2026 and stopped accepting new applications on 31 December 2025. The Self-Employed Persons Program is also paused, indefinitely.

Is Quebec included?

No. Quebec runs its own immigration programmes outside the federal system.

What is the minimum investment?

CAD \$100,000 is the lowest published threshold, in regional British Columbia, outside Halifax in Nova Scotia, and outside Yellowknife in the Northwest Territories. Larger centres run higher.

Do I need to create jobs?

Most provincial streams require one or two full-time jobs for Canadian citizens or permanent residents. The exact number depends on the stream and the region.

Can I apply for permanent residency directly?

Usually no. Most streams give you a work permit first, and you apply for PR after meeting the conditions of a performance agreement and showing you are actively running the business.

Can my family come with me?

Yes. Spouse and dependent children can be included under all of these streams.

Official sources: IRCC — Supplementary Information for the 2026-2028 Immigration Levels Plan; IRCC — Immigration measures for entrepreneurs (19 December 2025); Each programme page above links the province's own eligibility page..



NEXT STEP

Discuss your Canada options with our Dubai team

Tell us about your profile, family and timeline. We will compare the Canada routes that fit you, set out the full cost in writing and manage the application with you from start to finish.

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